

Connotation - Workbook 2

Focused practice - Workbook 2 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Weather Report

A headline says a storm will hammer the coast overnight, while the article itself says heavy rain and strong winds are expected.

1. What effect does hammer create?

- A. It makes the storm sound forceful and damaging.
- B. It makes the forecast uncertain.
- C. It makes the coast sound peaceful.
- D. It removes emotional language.

2. Which replacement is most neutral?

- A. attack
- B. strike
- C. affect
- D. punish

School Notice

The principal praised students who volunteered to stay after class, rather than saying they remained after class.

3. What does volunteered add?

- A. It suggests the students chose to help willingly.
- B. It proves the students were punished.
- C. It means they stayed overnight.
- D. It suggests the principal was angry.

4. How would remained change the effect?

- A. It would be more neutral about why they stayed.
- B. It would sound more approving.
- C. It would mean they left early.
- D. It would make the action impossible.

Restaurant Review

The reviewer described the dining room as compact rather than cramped.

5. Why is compact less negative?

- A. It suggests small size without strongly implying discomfort.
- B. It means the room is larger.
- C. It means the room is expensive.
- D. It has no meaning.

6. Which choice best describes the difference?

- A. same denotation, different connotation
- B. different facts, same attitude
- C. same spelling, different grammar
- D. opposite literal meanings

Answer key and reasoning

Weather Report

1. A. Hammer is a forceful loaded verb that intensifies the expected impact.
2. C. Affect states the relationship with the least emotional loading.

School Notice

3. A. Volunteered carries a positive association with willing service.
4. A. Remained states only that they stayed, not that they offered willingly.

Restaurant Review

5. A. Compact can be neutral or mildly positive, while cramped suggests uncomfortable lack of space.
6. A. Both indicate small size, but they frame that fact differently.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.